coronavirus pandemic in 2020 witnessed the largest drop in global poverty, global inequality (that is, between countries but not within countries), maternal and child mortality and illiteracy, and the sharpest rise in life expectancy around the world in history. [6] Despite the challenges of Covid-19, considerable progress was made in this period in combatting communicable diseases, including in eradicating smallpox and polio, and countering HIV/AIDS. Between the Congo wars in the mid-1990s and the Syrian civil war in 2011, international conflict became less common and less deadly. [7] Some of these trends are now witnessing reversals or are at grave risk of being overturned. It is all the more important that India lead efforts to rejuvenate multilateralism, create new institutions, and engage with a wider array of stakeholders from the developing world, many of whom share important aspects of India's concerns and outlook. Such efforts also advance Indian interests. They can enable India to favourably shape international rules and norms, advance preferred outcomes, and position itself as a leading power.

Priority 12. Revitalize Multilateral Institutions

In past eras, major conflicts such as world wars have represented opportunities to reset the institutions that represent the international order. For example, the Concert of Europe came out of the Napoleonic Wars, the League of Nations developed after World War I, and the United Nations after World War II. While fortunately the Cold War ended peacefully, there was no such opportunity to reset the fundamental terms of the international order. As such, the United Nations system and other international institutions have preserved, becoming increasingly outdated.

For all its limitations, the United Nations remains important. The UN General Assembly (UNGA) is by far the most representative international institution and thus an important forum for global discussions. In addition, it is also the basis for various economic and social agencies, the UNFCCC, and agreements such as the UN Convention on the Law of the Sea. But making the governance structures more representative and thus more